Maryam Abdulkarim

Product Designer (UI/UX)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Designer (UI/UX) with 3+ years of experience designing end-to-end, user-centred products in AI, fintech, edtech and climate tech for emerging markets, across web and mobile. Founder and product lead of EcoSmart AI, an award-winning AI recycling marketplace, and formerly the product designer on Carmpus, an AI adaptive learning platform, for two years. Skilled in user research, usability testing, interaction design, design systems and accessibility, working closely with engineers and stakeholders from discovery to handoff. Focused on AI that is honest about uncertainty and easy for people to correct.

CORE SKILLS

- **UX research:** user interviews, surveys, usability testing, contextual observation, competitor analysis, heuristic evaluation and product audits, personas, empathy mapping, journey mapping, affinity mapping, accessibility testing
- **Product design:** user-centred design, design thinking, user flows, information architecture, wireframing, low- and high-fidelity prototyping, UI design, interaction design, motion design (Lottie), design systems and tokens, responsive web and mobile design, accessibility (WCAG AA), developer handoff and design QA
- **AI product design:** AI-powered features, designing for AI uncertainty and user correction, AI output evaluation, prompt writing, AI-assisted prototyping
- **Design and prototyping tools:** Figma, Figma Make, Figma Draw, FigJam, Framer, Webflow, Bolt, Canva, Adobe Photoshop, LottieFiles
- **Research and collaboration tools:** Maze, Google Forms, Microsoft Forms, Zoom, Google Meet, Miro, Notion, Jira, Trello
- **AI tools:** Claude, ChatGPT, Figma AI, Google AI Studio
- **Technical and collaboration:** working knowledge of HTML, CSS and JavaScript (for developer collaboration and handoff); cross-functional work with engineers, stakeholder communication, design critique, teaching and mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Lead

EcoSmart AI and Innovation Ltd | Abuja, Nigeria — Apr 2026 – Present

- Founded a registered AI recycling marketplace that shows Nigerian households what their waste is worth and connects them with verified recyclers; lead a team of 5 across product, partnerships and fundraising. The company is a registered member of the Nigerian Association of Climate Change, Environment and Sustainability (NACES).
- Researched 57 recyclers and surveyed 157 households and businesses to define both sides of the marketplace.
- Designed the household and recycler journeys, including an AI scan result with a value range, an "AI verified" or "Self-reported" badge and a correction option, plus a fair final-price flow users can accept or flag.
- Built a design system of 41 colour tokens (light and dark), 11 text styles and 12 components for 360px screens and 48px touch targets; accessibility testing raised button contrast from 3.68:1 to 5.2:1.
- MVP tested by 50+ users, with a 130+ waitlist; raised ₦1M in non-dilutive funding from a grant and 1st-place wins at the Build4Today Female AI Hackathon and Flourish Her Africa pitch competition (2026). Case study: maryam-abdulkarim-portfolio.vercel.app/ecosmart.html | Website: ecosmartapp.com

Product Designer (UI/UX) (Full-time, Remote)

CodeBoulevard Systems Ltd | Lagos, Nigeria — Jan 2024 – Feb 2026

- Designed Carmpus, a learning management system that grew into an AI adaptive learning platform, for students, tutors and businesses across web and mobile (work under NDA; available on request).
- Mapped how each user group would use the platform and designed a dedicated user flow for each.
- Created wireframes, prototypes and high-fidelity UI in Figma, built on the team's design system, with design documentation for the product team.
- Ran usability tests with real users; when they found AI-generated screens hard to use, redesigned them with a more human-centred approach, then retested the new flows with users.
- Partnered with front-end and back-end developers from wireframe to release so the build matched the designs.

UI/UX Design Instructor (Part-time, Remote)

FocalLeap Limited | Abuja, Nigeria — Sep 2023 – Present

- Teach UI/UX design online to beginners, covering design fundamentals, wireframing, prototyping and the basics of how designs are built for the web.
- Guide learners through hands-on projects and give structured written and verbal design critiques, adapting explanations to different backgrounds and skill levels.
- Designed around 10 websites for FocalLeap clients, including polo clubs, apartments and foundations.

Graphic Designer & Content Creator (Remote)

Wale Grills | London, UK — Jan 2025 – Mar 2026

- Created social media graphics and short marketing videos, using performance data to improve later content.

Product (UI/UX) Design Intern (Remote)

Nigerian Women Techsters Fellowship, Tech4Dev — Nov 2023 – Oct 2024

- Completed a 1-year intensive product design programme, graduating Summa Cum Laude.

- Worked in a team to design two products, a sanitary pad app and a tech career finder, creating wireframes, prototypes and screens for web and mobile with a focus on accessibility.

Centre Administrator (Registrations, IT & Design)

IELTS Academy | Abuja, Nigeria — Nov 2021 – Jan 2024

- Registered 2,000+ candidates for IELTS classes and exams, contributing to the centre winning the British Council IELTS registration partnership award in 2023 and 2024.
- Ran day-to-day centre operations, including registrations, IT support and design materials.
- Coordinated British Council IELTS fairs in 2022/23, reaching 500+ attendees in total, and led a team of 8 to run a fair independently when the manager was unavailable.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Ajo Book (2026, live) – Solo Product Designer:** fintech web app that helps rotating savings group (ajo) holders keep payment records. Ran 12 in-person interviews and designed for low-cost Android phones and low tech confidence (18px+ text, 56px buttons, undo instead of pop-ups); built with Bolt and live with a real group holder, whose review produced 7 prioritised fixes. Case study: maryam-abdulkarim-portfolio.vercel.app/ajobook.html
- **Kioni (2026) – Product Designer:** redesign of a private work notebook for its founder, from a product audit and competitor review to a new design system and 22 core screens in light, dark and phone layouts, all WCAG AA. The founder adopted the redesign. Case study: maryam-abdulkarim-portfolio.vercel.app/kioni.html
- **Mimk (2024, redesigned 2026) – Product and UI/UX Designer:** booking platform for short-stay apartments in Nigeria, designed for its founder. Designed Version 1 in 2024, then redesigned it in 2026 around trust (inspected listings, all-in prices, hosts paid after check-in), covering guest, host and admin roles on desktop and mobile, with a design system and a clickable prototype of 122 screens. Case study: maryam-abdulkarim-portfolio.vercel.app/mimk.html

EDUCATION

B.Tech. Computer Science

Federal University of Technology, Minna, Nigeria — 2015 – 2021

- Relevant coursework: Human-Computer Interaction (A), Artificial Intelligence (A)

CERTIFICATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

UI/UX & Product Design

- UI/UX Product Design – Women Techsters Fellowship, Tech4Dev, 2024
- Figma UI UX Design Essentials – Udemy, 2025
- Figma to Lottie: Creating Lottie Animations – LottieFiles, in partnership with Figma, 2025
- Remote User Testing with UserTesting.com – LinkedIn Learning, 2024
- Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design – Google (Coursera), 2023
- Frontend Development – Tiidelab, 2023

AI & Professional

- AI Fluency: AI for Future Workforce – Microsoft Elevate / Digital Skills Nigeria, 2026
- Founderz AI & Business School Certification – AI Skills 4 Women (Microsoft), 2026

Memberships

- Professional Member – Association for Computing Machinery (ACM), 2026 – Present
- Member – Nigerian Association of Climate Change, Environment and Sustainability (NACES)

AWARDS & SELECTIONS

- 1st Place and grant, Build4Today Female AI Hackathon – Build Nigeria Initiative, 2026
- 1st Place and grant, Flourish Her Africa Pitch Competition – EcoSmart AI, 2026
- Scholarship recipient, Aspire Leaders Program (global cohort 3), 2026
- Digital Inclusion Champion Award – Angels of Hope Foundation, 2024
- Operational Excellence & Leadership Support Award – IELTS Academy, 2023/24

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

- Peter, O. O. E., Emakporuena, D., Tunde, B. D., Abdulkarim, M., & Umar, A. B. (2025). Transformer-Based Explainable Deep Learning for Breast Cancer Detection in Mammography: The MammoFormer Framework. *American Journal of Computer Science and Technology*, *8*(2), 121–137. doi.org/10.11648/j.ajcst.20250802.16
- Aliyu, M., Malum, S., & Abdulkarim, M. (2025). Empowering Student Entrepreneurs: An International Collaborative Network. Case Studies in International Education, 6(1), 13–15. csiepub.org/index.php/csie/article/view/172

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- **Ambassador (Sep 2026 – Present) and Gwagwalada Chapter Lead (Mar 2024 – Present), Women Techmakers:** lead the chapter, organise and host events, mentor young women in tech, and design community materials.
- **Hosted 4 community events for 300+ attendees in total (2024–2026):** GDG Gwagwalada I/O Extended (2024) and Build with AI (2025); International Women's Day "Redefine Possible" (2025) and "Break the Pattern" (2026, also as a speaker).
- **Volunteer, DevFest Abuja** (2023 and 2024).

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) | Hausa (Fluent) | Nigerian Pidgin (Fluent) | Ebira (Basic)